

Chris Davis 30-60-90 Day Plan

Framework for Senior Security/Compliance Leadership Roles

Goal: Immediate impact. Establish credibility as a technical compliance translator, build strategic relationships across the organization, and deliver measurable value. Enable business objectives.

Days 1-30: The "Assessment & Foundation" Phase

Theme: Learn, Listen, Establish Trust

The first 30 days focus on understanding the current state, identifying quick wins, and building the necessary relationships to drive change.

1. Organizational & Technical Discovery

- **Security Posture Assessment:** Review existing security documentation (SSPs, policies, control matrices, previous audit reports) to understand current compliance state and identify gaps
- **Stakeholder Mapping:** Meet 1-on-1 with key stakeholders including Engineering leadership, Legal, Privacy, Product Security, IT/Infrastructure, and business unit leaders to understand their pain points and security friction
- **Control Inventory:** Document existing security controls, tools, and processes across all domains (IAM, network security, data protection, monitoring, incident response)
- **Compliance Landscape:** Identify all applicable frameworks (FedRAMP, SOC 2, PCI DSS, HIPAA, CMMC, ISO 27001) and current certification/attestation status

2. Quick Assessment Activities

- **Shadow Security Reviews:** Observe current security review processes to identify bottlenecks and redundancies
- **Tool Audit:** Inventory security tooling to identify gaps, overlaps, and opportunities for consolidation
- **Documentation Review:** Assess quality and completeness of security documentation, evidence collection processes, and audit readiness

3. Relationship Building

- **Engineering Teams:** Establish rapport with development teams to understand how security requirements impact their velocity
- **Audit/Compliance Partners:** Connect with external auditors, 3PAOs, or assessment organizations to understand their expectations
- **Executive Leadership:** Brief C-suite on initial observations and build confidence in your strategic approach

Key Deliverables:

- Initial assessment report identifying top 3-5 opportunities for improvement
- Stakeholder map with documented pain points and priorities
- 30-day observations presentation for leadership
- Quick win identification (processes that can be improved immediately without major investment)

Days 31-60: The "Strategy & Quick Wins" Phase

Theme: Build Momentum Through Strategic Planning and Early Victories

Shift from assessment to action, delivering quick wins while building the foundation for longer-term strategic initiatives.

1. Strategic Program Development

- **Requirements Consolidation Plan:** Develop methodology for consolidating overlapping security requirements across frameworks
- **Control Framework Design:** Create unified control framework mapped to all applicable compliance standards

- **Evidence Automation Strategy:** Identify opportunities to automate evidence collection and compliance reporting
- **Security Review Optimization:** Design streamlined security review process consolidating inputs from multiple stakeholders

2. Quick Win Execution

- **Process Improvements:** Implement 2-3 immediate process improvements that reduce friction without compromising security (e.g., streamlined exception process, automated control validation)
- **Documentation Updates:** Update critical security documentation to improve audit readiness
- **Tool Integration:** Connect existing security tools to improve visibility and reduce manual work
- **Communication Framework:** Establish regular security program communications (metrics dashboards, stakeholder updates)

3. Program Infrastructure

- **Governance Model:** Establish security governance structure defining decision rights, escalation paths, and review cadences
- **Metrics Framework:** Define KPIs for security program effectiveness (not just compliance checkbox metrics)
- **Risk Management Process:** Implement risk-based approach to control prioritization and exception handling
- **Stakeholder Engagement Model:** Create structured engagement model with Engineering, Legal, and business units

Key Deliverables:

- Comprehensive security program strategy document
- Unified control framework (version 1.0) with framework mappings
- 2-3 successfully implemented quick wins with measured impact
- Security metrics dashboard operational
- Executive briefing on strategic direction and early wins

Days 61-90: The "Execution & Scale" Phase

Theme: Deliver Measurable Business Impact and Establish Long-Term Programs

Demonstrate ability to execute independently while building scalable programs that will deliver value beyond the first quarter.

1. Strategic Initiative Execution

- **Control Consolidation:** Complete first phase of requirements consolidation, reducing redundant controls and streamlining implementation
- **Automation Deployment:** Deploy first automation capabilities for evidence collection or control validation
- **Review Process Launch:** Roll out optimized security review process with stakeholder training
- **Framework Alignment:** Complete detailed mapping of security controls to all applicable compliance frameworks

2. Compliance Program Maturity

- **Audit Preparation:** If audit/assessment is pending, ensure complete preparation with organized evidence and control validation
- **Continuous Monitoring:** Implement continuous monitoring capabilities for critical controls
- **Exception Management:** Establish risk-based exception management process with clear criteria and approval workflows
- **Documentation Standards:** Implement documentation templates and standards ensuring consistency and audit readiness

3. Organizational Impact

- **Engineering Enablement:** Demonstrate measurable reduction in security review cycle time while maintaining control rigor
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Show successful collaboration across traditionally siloed teams

- **Risk Visibility:** Provide leadership with clear risk visibility and data-driven decision support
- **Program Advocacy:** Build internal advocacy for security program through demonstrated value delivery

Key Deliverables:

- Measurable reduction in security review cycle times (target: 30-40% improvement)
- Completed control framework with all framework mappings documented
- Operational automation for at least 2-3 high-volume evidence collection activities
- Successfully prepared for upcoming audit/assessment (if applicable)
- Quarterly security program review for executive leadership showing:
 - Program accomplishments
 - Risk posture improvements
 - Engineering velocity improvements
 - Roadmap for next quarter

Success Metrics (Adaptable to Specific Role)

Efficiency Metrics:

- Security review cycle time reduction
- Audit preparation time reduction
- Evidence collection automation percentage
- Control redundancy elimination

Effectiveness Metrics:

- Audit findings reduction (compared to previous period)
- Control coverage completeness
- Risk identification and remediation velocity
- Compliance certification/attestation success

Business Impact Metrics:

- Engineering team satisfaction with security process
- Time to market improvement for secure products
- Executive confidence in security posture
- Reduced compliance-related project delays

Strategic Positioning:

This plan demonstrates your ability to:

- Quickly assess complex environments and identify improvement opportunities
- Deliver immediate value while building long-term strategic programs
- Bridge technical implementation with regulatory requirements
- Enable business velocity through intelligent security architecture
- Build credibility through execution rather than just planning

Customization Notes

For specific roles, adjust emphasis:

- **Federal/Public Sector:** Emphasize FedRAMP, ATO optimization, eMASS integration
- **Healthcare:** Focus on HIPAA, HITRUST, patient data protection
- **Financial Services:** Highlight PCI DSS, SOX, regulatory examination preparation
- **Technology/SaaS:** Emphasize SOC 2, customer security requirements, DevSecOps integration
- **AI/ML Companies:** Focus on AI governance frameworks, emerging standards, model security